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WORLD OF FOOTBALL

AP

SACKINGS, SPECTACLES AND SILVERWARE

A dramatic week saw managerial firings, derby drama and **shifting momentum** across the world's top leagues and tournaments.



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Aneesh Dey and Joan Mathew Jacob

aneesh.dey@thehindu.co.in, joan.mathew@thehindu.co.in



REUTERS

The winds of change blew over English top-flight football with the Premier League witnessing the exit of two big-club managers. While one was somewhat anticipated, the other came as a shock.

Enzo Maresca (**left**) and Chelsea mutually parted ways after its 2-2 draw against Bournemouth. Maresca's falling out with the Chelsea hierarchy had become public news, and it was just a matter of time before the Italian departed from Stamford Bridge.

After appointing Calum McFarlane, who oversaw a 1-1 draw against Manchester City and a 1-2 loss against Bournemouth, the Blues appointed Strasbourg coach Liam Rosenior on a six-and-a-half-year contract.

After Manchester United's 1-1 draw against Leeds, Ruben Amorim (**above**), who is known

for his calm demeanour, gave an explosive post-match press conference, saying that his role is that of a 'manager', not just 'head coach'. Media reports hinted that his speech took subtle digs at the Man United board, with the Portuguese calling out the media for 'selective information'.

The next day, Amorim got sacked with Darren Fletcher being appointed as interim coach, who oversaw a 2-2 draw against Burnley. While it remains to be seen who gets the role of Amorim's successor, Michael Carrick is reported to be a front-runner for the job already.

In other news, league leader Arsenal dropped points against